PYTHON · UGLY 80 · 1/10

I like the unglamorous 80% of the work.

Why the least visible layer of a system usually carries the most leverage.

10 slides · swipe

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Not features. The glue.

Imports, schema migrations, broken rows, dead integrations, half-filled forms — nobody demos these. Everyone depends on them. The 80% that decides whether the demo survives contact.

Nobody gets promoted for glue.
Yet nothing ships without it.

PYTHON · WHAT I FIX · 3/10

The unglamorous work I volunteer for.

01 Importers that choke on real customers' Excel

02 Integrations between systems that never agreed on format

03 Half-filled forms nobody modeled — handled gracefully

04 Data quality checks nobody would build but everyone needs

05 Migration scripts and the runbooks nobody reads

Boring is a strategy. The incidents hide elsewhere.

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Why the ugly 80 matters more than the 20.

Users experience your glue, not your architecture. Make the glue honest.

The elegant 20 gets the conference talk. The 80 gets the customer.

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What good glue looks like.

VIDEO TOUR

Demo-driven

works on one perfect file
breaks silently otherwise
nobody reads the code

MONDAY MORNING

Battle-tested

survives real uploads
errors are legible
next dev understands it

Choose your definition of 'done' before the demo — not after the outage.

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What the 20% hides behind.

Every beautiful feature sits on top of import/export/cleanup/migration code nobody budgeted for. Skip the grime and the magic breaks in production — every single time.

The magic is the 20.
The plumbing is the 80.

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PYTHON · FOR YOU · 7/10

Find your 80% this week.

01 What breaks silently at 3 a.m.?

02 What manual step does the team complain about daily?

03 What file import would confuse a new hire?

04 What dead integration has a cron entry nobody audited?

Answer any one. That's your project, this sprint.

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What I look for in a role.

Someone who understands the business touches the keyboard. I want the broken process with real users — the one where fixing glue beats rewriting the platform.

Real users. Real mess.
Real leverage.

The hiring signal I actually trust.

Show me the last thing you fixed that nobody asked you to — that's the whole interview.

Frameworks are table stakes. Unprompted honesty commitments aren't.

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PYTHON · KEEP THIS · 10/10

Send me the role at your company.

If your Python codebase has an unowned 80% — messy imports, half-systems, manual reconciliations — that's the work I want. antonpetnitsky.com

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